

Overview

Spatial modelling will be used to better understand feral pig distributions and their ecology, enabling cost-effective strategies for feral pig management.

The data generated from this project will inform strategic decision-making within biosecurity incident responses affecting feral and domestic pig populations.

Project Lead: Queensland Department of Primary Industries

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Project Status: Complete

Objective alignment:

- 1 – Improve Australia’s preparedness and ability to respond to emergency animal diseases.

Activity alignment:

- 1.4 – Undertake projects, including commissioning and research, to further develop economic analyses and epidemiological modelling tools supporting rapid decision-making in emergency animal disease responses for priority diseases.

Project updates

August 2025

A manuscript, [Variable response to aerial culling demonstrates adaptability of feral pigs](#) has been published in the international journal [Applied Animal Behaviour Science](#).

May 2025

The study on the behavioural (movement) response of feral pigs to aerial control was presented at the Australasian Vertebrate Pest Conference in Sydney, New South Wales on 1 August 2024.

Watch the presentation by Dr Catherine Kelly on [Variable responses to aerial control](#).

February 2025

A fourth scientific paper was published in *Wildlife Research* on 16 April 2024.

November 2023

Biosecurity Queensland’s feral pig spatial modelling has improved understanding of feral pig distributions and their ecology. This will enable cost-effective strategies for feral pig management.

Three scientific papers were published in Wildlife Research, Australian Mammalogy and the Australian Veterinary Journal.

In addition, a comprehensive public report on the effectiveness and efficiencies of feral pig control tools has been developed.

An internal-only report on the capacity of Queensland stakeholders to control feral pigs was also prepared.

See more

Read the publications related to this project and feral pig control and management:

- [Enhancing strategic deployment of baiting transects for invasive species control – a case study for feral pig baiting in north-eastern Australia](#) (Wildlife Research, 2024)
- [Factors influencing the activity ranges of feral pigs \(*Sus scrofa*\) across four sites in eastern Australia](#) (Wildlife Research, 2023)
- [Feral pig \(*Sus scrofa*\) activity and landscape feature revisitation across four sites in eastern Australia](#) (Australian Mammalogy, 2023)
- [Feral pig management in Australia: implications for disease control](#) (Australian Veterinary Journal, 2022)
- [Feral pig control techniques - A review and discussion of efficacy and efficiency for application in Queensland](#) (Queensland Government, 2022)

Tags: Complete, Objective 1

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/health/animal-plan/project-17>